

USUCGER Student Travel Grants January 1, 2027 to April 30, 2027

Summary

The USUCGER Board will sponsor students (graduate or undergraduate) to attend conferences between **January 1, 2027 and April 30, 2027** in support of their accepted work. The awards will be up to \$1,000 per student and may be used to fund airfare, hotel, per diem, and/or the conference student registration fee for the awardee.

Applicants must be advised by a USUCGER member and must be presenting research that contributes to the body of knowledge in geotechnical or geoenvironmental engineering to be eligible for the award. The award can be used to support travel to geotechnical and/or geoenvironmental-focused or interdisciplinary conferences.

The Board will evaluate applications during two upcoming cycles and anticipates granting at least one travel award per cycle depending on available funding. A summary of the application cycle dates and deadlines is provided below. Separate solicitations will be sent via email from the USUCGER Board for each award cycle.

Date of Conference Attendance	Application Deadline	Anticipated Award Notification Date
January 1 to April 30, 2027 (this cycle)	November 15, 2026	December 15, 2026
May 1 to August 31, 2027(next cycle)	March 15, 2027	April 15, 2027

Eligibility

To be eligible for the award, an applicant must (i) be enrolled at a U.S. member university and be advised (or co-advised) by a current USUCGER member at the time of application; (ii) have an abstract or paper submitted for presentation at the conference (oral or poster); (iii) commit to presenting the submitted work, either through a poster presentation, podium presentation, or similar (e.g., lightning presentation), at the conference; and (iv) not have sufficient funding through other travel awards. Each USUCGER member may nominate only one student per application cycle. If multiple nominations are submitted by the same member, only the first nomination will be considered.

Application Requirements

An application package must include the following two items prepared by the applicant:

1. A single PDF file (named *LastName.pdf*, where LastName is the surname of the applicant) containing:
 - A one-page letter, written on university letterhead and signed, from the student's faculty advisor confirming the student's (a) *qualifications*; (b) *eligibility* for the award; (c) *contributions* to the work in relation to the other authors; and

- (d) *presentation* of the work at the conference. The letter may be included in the application package, or submitted separately at this [link](#);
- Student's current CV not to exceed three pages;
 - A brief (not to exceed one page, single-spaced, 12-pt. font) essay stating the conference they will be traveling to, describing: (a) how attending the conference connects with their education, research, and career goals; and (b) how they expect to benefit from attending the conference programming (e.g., committee meetings, workshops, sessions, presentations);
 - An itemized summary of estimated travel costs and how costs greater than the \$1000 travel award will be covered (e.g., through other travel grants, project funds);
 - A copy of the abstract(s) submitted to the conference; do not submit the full paper.
2. A brief (not to exceed three minutes) recorded video presentation in which the student summarizes their submitted research work. The video should explain the motivation, key methods, and main findings of the work. Students are encouraged to highlight their personal role in the project. Visual aids (e.g., slides, videos, animations) may be used but are not required. The video presentation may be uploaded as a video file (with the same naming structure as the application file) or may be provided as a link to a video on a website (please include the URL in your PDF application package). These videos will be evaluated by the USUCGER Board based on communication, creativity, and quality of the work.

Students applying for international travel support must be legally able to travel (i.e., approved visa or eligible for a visa waiver) to the proposed country at the time of the application.

Prior to accepting the award, the student must provide confirmation from the conference organizers that the paper has been accepted and has been assigned to a technical session for oral or poster presentation (e.g., a copy of the email confirming acceptance).

Selection Criteria

The selection committee will be composed at a minimum of three USUCGER board members. Selection of the awardee will be based on evaluation of the entire application package, including the potential effects of the award on the student's career (as evidenced in the essay and CV).

Award Amount

The award will be based on the actual cost of attending the conference but **may not exceed \$1,000 per awardee**. Eligible expenses for reimbursement through this award include airfare (main cabin only), baggage fees, lodging (actual single room rate), conference registration, transportation to and from the airport, and meals and incidental expenses (up to \$60/day with itemized receipts). Alcohol and expenses associated with personal business and side trips are not reimbursable.

Students must make their own travel arrangements prior to the conference and will be reimbursed by the USUCGER after completion of the conference. Students will be asked to certify that the submitted expenses will not be otherwise reimbursed (e.g., by other grants or scholarships). Original itemized receipts and a completed reimbursement form will be required.

If this conference is transitioned to virtual attendance, the USUCGER Board maintains the right to revoke travel grant decisions. The Board may cover cancellation fees incurred by the selected students at the Board's discretion.

Deadline

Completed application packages should be submitted electronically (as a single file) to the [online form](#) no later than 11:59 PM PST on the relevant deadline outlined above. No extensions will be given.

Additional Information

Send an email to uboard@usucger.org with any questions or requests for additional information.